

Presentation Script: The History of SQL

A 5-Minute Overview Slide-by-Slide

SLIDE 1: TITLE SLIDE

Hi everyone, today I'm going to walk you through the history of SQL. It stands for Structured Query Language, and for over 50 years, it has been the primary way we talk to databases and manage the world's data. [cite: 57, 73]

SLIDE 2: THE FOUNDATION (1970)

It all started in 1970 with Dr. Edgar F. Codd. Before his work, data was stored in messy, complicated networks that looked like giant webs. He proposed a new Relational Model where data is organized into simple, clean tables, much like a spreadsheet. This simple idea changed everything. [cite: 58, 74]

SLIDE 3: IBM SYSTEM R

Building on Codd's ideas, researchers Donald Chamberlin and Raymond Boyce at IBM created the first version of the language to interact with the System R project. Their goal was simple: make a language that looks like plain English so that regular people, not just math experts, could use it to find information. [cite: 59, 75]

SLIDE 4: FROM SEQUEL TO SQL

Interestingly, SQL wasn't the first name; it was originally called SEQUEL, or Structured English Query Language. However, an airplane company in the UK already owned that trademark. To avoid a legal battle, IBM had to drop the vowels, and it became SQL. Even today, many people still pronounce it 'sequel' as a nod to that history instead of saying the letters S-Q-L. [cite: 60, 61, 62, 76]

SLIDE 5: BECOMING THE GLOBAL STANDARD

By the late 70s and 80s, SQL exploded globally. Oracle released the first commercial version in 1979, and by 1986, it became an official ANSI standard. This meant that no matter what brand of computer or software you used, the language for data was finally the same everywhere. [cite: 63, 77]

SLIDE 6: THE EVOLUTION OF SYNTAX

SQL hasn't stayed stuck in the past; it constantly evolves as technology changes. In the 90s, it added complex triggers, followed by XML support in the early 2000s and JSON support in 2016. Just last year, in 2023, it was updated again to handle even more complex modern data relationships. [cite: 64, 78]

SLIDE 7: WHY IT WORKS (THE "WHAT" VS "HOW")

The secret to SQL's success is that it is declarative. This is a fancy way of saying you tell the database what you want—for example, asking for all employee names—and the database's brain, the optimizer, figures out the best way to find it. It is like ordering a pizza: you tell the shop you want a Pepperoni pizza without having to explain how to knead the dough or set the oven temperature. [cite: 65, 66, 79, 80]

SLIDE 8: ADAPTING TO BIG DATA

In the late 2000s, some thought SQL would die because of Big Data and the NoSQL movement. However, SQL adapted perfectly and now powers the world's biggest cloud data warehouses like Snowflake, BigQuery, Google, and Amazon. It proved it could handle massive amounts of information just as well as newer technologies. [cite: 67, 68, 81]

SLIDE 9: THE KING OF DATA TODAY

In conclusion, SQL is the ultimate survivor and king of the tech world. Whether you are building a mobile app, working in finance, or using Python for AI, SQL is the foundation. It is mature, reliable, simple, and powerful, making it the most important skill for anyone working with data. [cite: 69, 82]

SLIDE 10: THANK YOU

That concludes our 50-year journey of SQL, from a research paper at IBM to the language that runs the modern internet. Thank you for listening, and please let me know if you have any questions. [cite: 70, 82]